

Benjamin Ward

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SUMMARY

IT & Cybersecurity Leader with 10+ years of progressive experience building, scaling, and securing technology environments. Trusted executive partner with experience leading infrastructure, cybersecurity, governance, compliance, and cross-functional technology initiatives supporting organizations of 1,000+ employees. Combines strategic planning and organizational leadership with deep technical expertise to translate business objectives into secure, scalable technology programs and drive complex initiatives from strategy through implementation.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sr Manager of Infrastructure and Security, Divisions Maintenance Group

June 2025 – Present

- Own enterprise infrastructure and cybersecurity strategy, developing technology roadmaps and KPIs that guide executive investment, resource allocation, risk management, and growth priorities.
- Lead infrastructure and security teams totaling eight professionals supporting 1,200 employees and 2,400 endpoints across the enterprise.
- Partner with executive, Product & Engineering, Legal, Sales, and business leadership to translate organizational objectives and customer requirements into scalable technology and cybersecurity initiatives.
- Directed enterprise security modernization from architecture through implementation, migrating EDR, identity threat detection and response, vulnerability management, and GRC platforms to strengthen defense-in-depth capabilities and reduce incident response times by 60%.
- Orchestrate enterprise security governance across NIST CSF, SOC 2 Type 2, and PCI-DSS, directing control implementation, risk remediation, audit readiness, and continuous compliance.
- Own annual infrastructure and cybersecurity budgets and strategic vendor portfolio, reduced annual technology spend by \$440,000 through vendor consolidation and licensing optimization while expanding security capabilities.

IT and Security Manager, Slope

Nov 2023 – June 2025

- Led SOC 2 and FedRAMP Li-SaaS readiness programs, translating requirements into technical and administrative controls and coordinating implementation across Engineering, IT, Security, and Operations.
- Built and operationalized the incident response program, establishing investigation procedures, root-cause analysis, and response playbooks to improve detection and response capabilities.
- Built and scaled enterprise IT and security operations encompassing service management, identity governance, access reviews, security policy, and automated service workflows, creating repeatable processes capable of supporting organizational growth.
- Served as technical escalation lead for complex infrastructure, SaaS, and security issues while owning broader IT/security initiatives and driving projects through implementation.

IT Operations and Security Manager, Arturo

Oct 2021 – July 2023

- Led strategic and day-to-day IT/security operations for a 150+ employee remote organization, balancing technology strategy, reliability, cybersecurity, compliance, and employee experience.
- Owned a 200+ application SaaS environment, including Google Workspace, Slack, Zoom, and identity/access platforms, maintaining 99.9% availability.
- Designed zero-touch provisioning with Apple Business Manager and Rippling MDM while automating IT workflows, reducing provisioning time 75% and increasing operational efficiency.
- Directed concurrent SOC 2 Type 2 and ISO 27001 certification programs from initial readiness through successful certification in under 12 months, coordinating control implementation, remediation, policy development, auditors, and cross-functional stakeholders.
- Led IT/security personnel and partnered with Finance, HR, Engineering, and leadership to prioritize technology initiatives and resolve operational and security risks.

IT Lead, Togo Group

Jan 2020 – Oct 2021

- Led Mosyle MDM deployment across 150+ endpoints, implementing zero-touch provisioning and reducing device setup time >80%.
- Managed AWS, GitLab, Microsoft 365, and other critical SaaS platforms supporting 100+ users while maintaining 99.9% availability.
- Designed Cisco Meraki network/security infrastructure and led a cross-functional security committee that established the organization's risk register and risk-management practices.

Sr. System Administrator II, Flavor Producers

May 2017 – Nov 2019

- Modernized infrastructure across four offices in two states, deploying Cisco Meraki networking and resilient local/offsite backup architecture while achieving 99.8% network availability.
- Led Microsoft 365 deployment and training for 200+ employees, achieving >95% adoption within two months.
- Led technology integration across three company mergers, standardizing systems and onboarding while reducing onboarding time >50% and maintaining operational continuity.

CERTIFICATIONS

CISSP • CISM • SecurityX • CySA+ • CCSP • SSCP • Security+ • Project+

EDUCATION

MS Cybersecurity & Information Assurance - Western Governors University | 2025